

VPN Policy

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Policy Owner	Information Security Officer
Department	Information Technology
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1. Purpose

This policy defines how employees and vendors may securely connect to Beacon's internal systems from outside the office network.

2. Scope

This policy applies to all employees, contractors and vendors who access Beacon's internal systems remotely, including during work-from-home days (BT-HR-003) and business travel.

3. Key Requirements

Item	Requirement
VPN client	Beacon Secure Connect (installed by IT on company laptops)
Devices allowed	Company-issued laptops only
Authentication	Username, password and MFA on every connection
Idle timeout	Disconnected after 30 minutes of inactivity
Maximum session	12 hours, then reconnect
Tunnel mode	Full tunnel (no split tunnelling)
Log retention	12 months

4. Main Rules

4.1 When VPN Is Required

- Employees working remotely must connect to the company VPN when accessing internal systems.
- Internal systems include the file servers, code repositories, the Beacon Finance Portal, the Beacon People Portal, internal dashboards and test environments.
- Company email and chat are cloud services and do not need the VPN, but they require MFA.
- The VPN is not required when connected to the Beacon office network.

4.2 Getting Access

- VPN access is set up for every employee on their date of joining on the company laptop.

- If access is lost or not working, raise a request with the IT Service Desk at extension 4000.

4.3 Secure Use

- VPN credentials and MFA codes must not be shared.
- Do not use the VPN on personal laptops, shared computers or public computers.
- Public Wi-Fi (airports, cafes, hotels) may be used only when the VPN is connected. A mobile hotspot is also allowed.
- Home routers should use WPA2 or stronger encryption, and the default router password must be changed.
- Employees must disconnect from the VPN when they have finished work or step away for a long time.

4.4 Access from Outside India

- Remote work from outside India is not permitted (see BT-HR-003).
- Employees travelling abroad on business may use the VPN if they request approval from the Information Security Officer through the Service Desk at least 3 working days in advance. Access from some countries may be restricted.

4.5 Vendors and Contractors

- Vendors need a Beacon sponsor (a Department Head or manager) and must sign the confidentiality agreement.
- Vendor VPN access is limited to specific systems and expires after a maximum of 90 days. It can be renewed by the sponsor.

4.6 If the VPN Is Not Working

Employees must not try to bypass the VPN to reach internal systems. They should inform the IT Service Desk and their manager and work on tasks that do not need internal systems until it is restored.

4.7 Monitoring

VPN connection logs are monitored and kept for 12 months. Unusual activity, such as logins from unexpected locations, may lead to access being blocked until verified.

5. Exceptions

- Temporary exceptions for specific systems that cannot be reached via the VPN may be approved by the Information Security Officer for up to 30 days.
- Emergency access for critical production support may be given by the Head of IT with a record of the reason.

Internal Use Only

Beacon Technologies Pvt. Ltd.

Synthetic document created for a technology prototype.